

Self-Identifying: (Floppy Edition)

PostScript program on Floppy Disk,
dimensions variable, Rhea Myers, 2025

About

This work from the series Self-Identifying: (Floppy Edition) is an image-generating program written in PostScript, formerly the lingua franca of design and printing. It has been turned into a self-referential and self-reproducing Quine program that prints its own source code. While it is doing so, it creates a cryptographic identity not just for but of itself, and cryptographically signs its image with it. This mirrors the cypherpunk conceptions of personhood and political subjectivity that gave us Bitcoin.

Bitcoin secures the being of its value and its users from state intervention with cryptographic identities managed by a simple scripting language called Script that curiously resembles PostScript in both name and structure. Unlike Script, PostScript is Turing Complete - it has loops.

This is why it can access other resources on the computer it is running on, including command-line cryptography tools.

The crypto community's statement "Not your keys, not your coins" is the "I think therefore I am" of the blockchain age. Through its self-verifying code, Self-Identifying:(Floppy Edition) asserts these historical philosophical ideas of selfhood against the contemporary backlash against self-determination.

Requirements

To read this file and access the others on this disk you will need to have a floppy disk drive. Before doing anything else you should create a copy of this disk. You have explicit authorization to do so as many times as needed to ensure that you retain access to its content while the original is in your possession. (If in doubt, take a copy.)

To run the PostScript program via the included Makefile, you will need the following software installed:

`base64`, `cut`, `ecdsasign`, `GhostScript`, `Make`, `sha256sum`, `xxd`

To rebuild the image files, which will erase the originals, enter a Unix shell and type the following, using the correct path to the drive containing the floppy disk containing these files.

```
cd /PATH/TO/THE/FLOPPY
make clean
make
```

Display

The PNG of the image is sized for screen display.

Should you need a different sized image, you can rasterize the PDF to produce it.

Printing

The PDF of each image should produce high-quality prints. The document size is ANSI C.

Notes

macOS Preview.app mangles the images in bitmap/graymap/pixmap. They show OK in other PDF viewers, notably Acrobat.

Floppy Disk Care

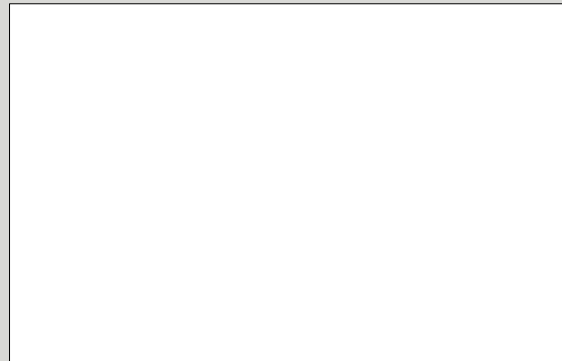


Floppy disks are an aging, fragile medium

Make sure not to:

- Pull back the metal cover for the disk.
- Touch the disk inside its case.
- Let dust or moisture enter the disk case.
- Use magnets or sources of magnetism near the disk.
- Let the disk get too hot or cold (10-60°C / 50-140°F).

Certified Authentic



<https://rhea.art>

Self-Identifying (Floppy Edition)

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